Telling the time

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Ask and answer «What time is it?»
- Say o'clock, half past, quarter past and quarter to
- Tell the time in five-minute steps with past and to
- Talk about the time of your activities

Para pensar

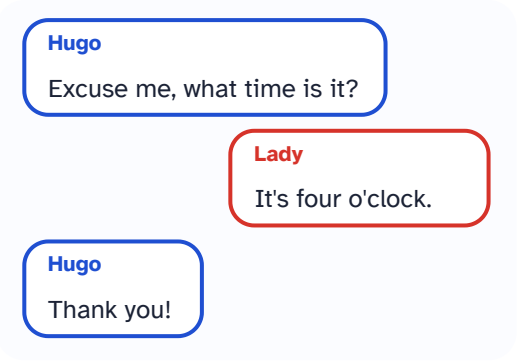
En español decimos «son las cinco y cuarto» y «son las seis menos cuarto». ¿Cómo lo dirán en inglés?

Explicación

What time is it?

To ask the time, we say: « What time is it? » or «**What's the time?**». To answer, we start with «**It's...**»: «It's three o'clock», «It's half past four».

En castellano: «¿Qué hora es?» se traduce como «What time is it?», palabra por palabra «¿qué hora es ello?». En inglés siempre necesitamos un sujeto, por eso empezamos la respuesta con *It*'s (it is). Si quieres ser muy educado con un desconocido, di: «**Excuse me, what time is it, please?**»



The clock: hours and minutes

A clock has two **hands** (agujas). The short hand shows the **hour** and the long hand shows the **minutes**. The long hand goes all around the clock in one hour: 60 minutes.

The numbers 1 to 12 show the hours, and between them there are little marks for the minutes: each number means **five minutes** for the long hand. So when the long hand points to 3, it's 15 minutes; to 6, it's 30 minutes. **En castellano:** agujas = *hands*, como las manos del reloj.



O'clock

When the long hand points to **12**, we say o'clock: «It's **one o'clock**», «It's **seven o'clock**», «It's **twelve o'clock**». The short hand tells you the number.

O'clock is a short way of saying «of the clock». We only use it for exact hours, never with minutes: we say «It's six o'clock», but not «It's six and ten o'clock». **En castellano:** equivale a decir «en punto»: «Son las siete en punto».



Half past

When the long hand points to **6**, it has gone half way round the clock: 30 minutes. We say half past + the hour: «It's **half past two**» (las dos y media), «It's **half past nine**» (las nueve y media).

Careful: the short hand is between two numbers. It's half past two when the short hand is **between 2 and 3**. We always say the number it has already passed.
Truco: *past* significa «pasado»: la hora ya ha pasado y llevamos media hora más.



Quarter past and quarter to

A quarter is a fourth part: 15 minutes. When the long hand points to **3**, we say **quarter past**: «It's quarter past eight» (las ocho y cuarto).

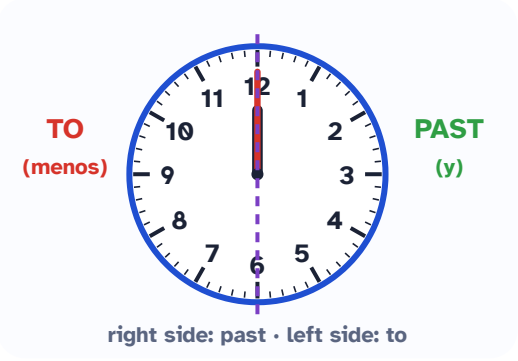
When the long hand points to **9**, there are 15 minutes left to the next hour. We say **quarter to** + the next hour: «It's **quarter to nine**» (las nueve menos cuarto). **En castellano:** *past* es «y» (después de la hora) y *to* es «menos» (antes de la hora siguiente).



Five, ten, twenty, twenty-five

For other minutes, count in fives with the long hand. From 12 to 6 (the right side), we use past: five past, ten past, quarter past, twenty past, twenty-five past. «It's **ten past four**» (las cuatro y diez).

From 6 to 12 (the left side), we use to and the next hour: twenty-five to, twenty to, quarter to, ten to, five to. «It's **twenty to five**» (las cinco menos veinte). **En castellano:** es igual que en español, que también contamos «y» en la primera mitad y «menos» en la segunda.



Morning or evening? a.m. and p.m.

In English we usually use a **12-hour clock**. To show if it's before or after midday, we can say a.m. (from midnight to midday) or p.m. (from midday to midnight): «School starts at 9 a.m.», «The film starts at 6 p.m.».

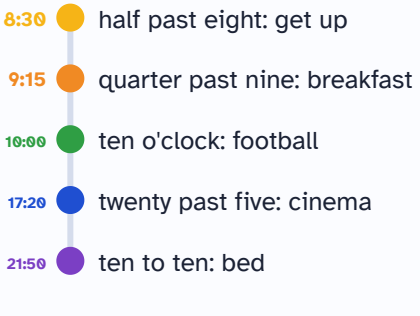
In conversation it's more common to say «in the morning», «in the afternoon», «in the evening»: «I get up at seven **in the morning**». **En castellano:** en España usamos mucho el reloj de 24 horas (las 18:00), pero en inglés suele decirse *six p.m.* o *six in the evening*.

24 h	English
08:00	8 a.m.
12:00	midday / noon
18:00	6 p.m.
00:00	midnight

Reading: Sam's busy Saturday

Read about Sam's day: «On Saturdays I get up at **half past eight**. At **quarter past nine** I have breakfast with my grandma. My football match starts at **ten o'clock** and finishes at **quarter to twelve**. In the afternoon I go to the cinema with my cousin. The film starts at **twenty past five**. I have dinner at **half past eight** and I go to bed at **ten to ten**.»

Draw the hands on six clocks for Sam's day. Which activity is the longest? At what time does the football match finish?



Let's practise: what's the time, Mr Wolf?

Play outside! One player is the **wolf** and stands with their back to the others. The group walks slowly and asks: «**What's the time, Mr Wolf?**». The wolf answers a time, for example «**It's three o'clock!**», and the group takes three steps. When

the wolf says «**It's dinner time!**», everybody runs back and the wolf tries to catch someone.

In class, make a paper clock with a split pin (encuadernador). Your partner says a time and you move the hands. Then change roles.



paper clock + split pin

Telling the time

:00	:15	:30	:45
O'CLOCK	**QUARTER PAST**	**HALF PAST**	**QUARTER TO**
It's two o'clock. en punto	quarter past two y cuarto	half past two y media	quarter to three menos cuarto

Ejercicios

1. **How do you ask the time in English?**

2. **Say the time: 5:00.**

3. **Say the time: 9:30.**

4. **Say the time: 2:15.**

5. **Say the time: 7:45.**

6. **Say the time: 10:10.**

7. **Say the time: 4:35.**

8. **Translate: «las doce y veinte».**

9. **Is 8 p.m. in the morning or in the evening?**

10. **Write the time of two things you do every day.**

Practica

1. **«¿Qué hora es?» is...**

   A) How time is it?

   B) What hour is?

   C) What time is it?

2. **The long hand shows...**

   A) the minutes

   B) the hours

   C) the days

3. **3:00 is...**

   A) half past three

   B) three o'clock

   C) quarter to three

4. **4:30 is...**

   A) half to four

   B) half past four

   C) half past five

5. **6:15 is...**

   A) quarter to six

   B) fifteen to six

   C) quarter past six

6. **8:45 is...**

   A) quarter to nine

   B) quarter to eight

   C) quarter past eight

7. **1:10 is...**

   A) ten to one

   B) one past ten

   C) ten past one

8. **«To» means...**

   A) y

B) menos

C) en punto

9. **5:40 is...**

A) twenty to six

B) twenty past five

C) forty to six

10. **7 p.m. is...**

A) in the evening

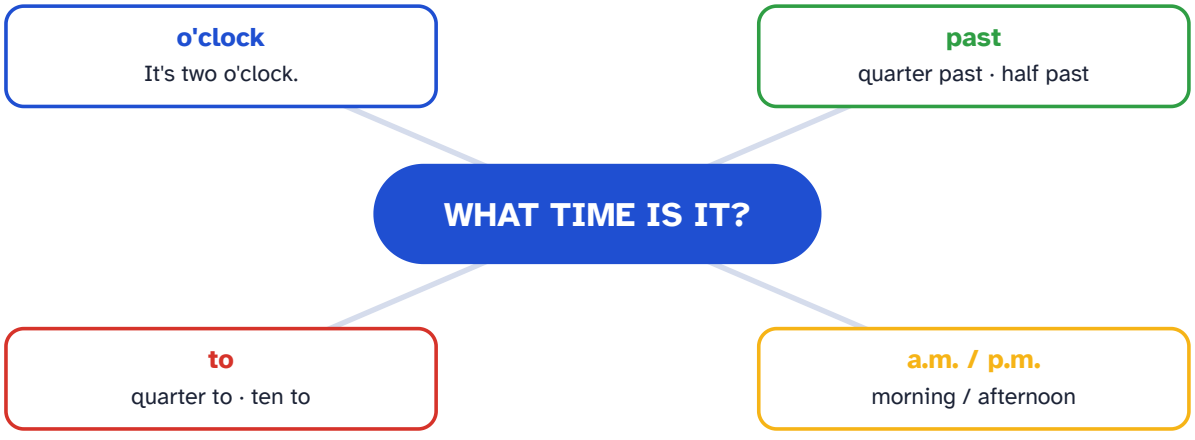
B) in the morning

C) at midnight

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Cómo se pregunta y se dice la hora en inglés; Qué indican las dos agujas del reloj; Cuándo se usa past y cuándo to; Qué significan a.m. y p.m..

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

What time is it?

¿Qué hora es?

o'clock

En punto.

half past

Y media.

quarter past

Y cuarto.

quarter to

Menos cuarto (con la hora siguiente).

past

Y (lado derecho del reloj).

to

Menos (lado izquierdo del reloj).

a.m. / p.m.

Antes / después de mediodía.

Soluciones

1. **C)** What time is it?
2. **A)** Larga = minutos.
3. **B)** En punto.
4. **B)** Y media.
5. **C)** Y cuarto.
6. **A)** Hora siguiente con to.
7. **C)** Minutos + past + hora.
8. **B)** Antes de la hora.
9. **A)** Faltan 20 para las 6.
10. **A)** p.m. = después de mediodía.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. What time is it? / What's the time?
2. It's five o'clock.
3. It's half past nine.
4. It's quarter past two.
5. It's quarter to eight.
6. It's ten past ten.
7. It's twenty-five to five.
8. twenty past twelve.
9. In the evening (20:00).
10. Model answer: I get up at quarter to eight. I have dinner at half past eight.